

Stayman and Jacoby Transfers

The Stayman convention is used to find a 4-4 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. Responder bids an artificial 2♣ and the Notrump bidder then bids a 4-card Major if she has one, or 2 or 3 ♦ otherwise.

The Jacoby Transfer convention is used to uncover a 5-3 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. A response of ♦s asks opener to bid ♥s, a response of ♥s asks opener to bid ♠s.

The two conventions complement each other, that's why they are together in this set of practices.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2 ♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♥ 3

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4 ♥

Declarer: East

Lead: ♦ J

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♥ 5

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: West

Lead: ♣ K

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦ Q

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 10
 ♥ K Q 10 9
 ♦ J 10 6 2
 ♣ 10 6 2

♠ K J 5

♥ A 7 6

♦ A 8 3

♣ K Q 9 4



♠ 9 4

♥ J 4 3 2

♦ K Q 7

♣ A J 8 7

♠ Q 8 7 6 3 2

♥ 8 5

♦ 9 5 4

♣ 5 3

NORTH, with a balanced 17 point hand naturally opens 1NT.

SOUTH has a really awful hand, but she does hold six ♠s. So she uses Jacoby Transfer, and when NORTH bids 2♠ she passes!

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

2♥

Pass

2♠

All Pass

2♠ by North

Lead: ♥3

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A K 7 2

♥ A J 8 6

♦ 5 3

♣ 10 8 4

♠ J 10 9 8

♥ 5 3

♦ K Q 4 2

♣ 6 5 2



♠ Q 6 3

♥ Q 10 9 2

♦ A 7 6

♣ A K 3

♠ 5 4

♥ K 7 4

♦ J 10 9 8

♣ Q J 9 7

WEST has four cards in each Major suit - this is an ideal situation for Stayman.

EAST shows a ♥ suit and WEST immediately bids game in that suit.

*West**North**East**South*

2♣

Pass

1NT

Pass

4♥

2♥

Pass

All Pass

4♥ by East

Lead: ♦J

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 6
♥ 10 7 5
♦ A 8 5
♣ K 10 7 4 2

♠ K 9 7 4

♥ K 8 6 2

♦ 7 3

♣ 8 6 5



♠ 10 5 3

♥ J 9 4

♦ Q J 9 4

♣ J 9 3

♠ A Q 8 2

♥ A Q 3

♦ K 10 6 2

♣ A Q

Stayman convention works just fine after a 2NT opening, just at a higher level.

NORTH knows that 6 points will be enough for game opposite SOUTH's 20-21, she just needs to find out if there is a 4-4 Major suit fit. There is, in ♠s.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			2NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♥5			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 10
 ♥ K 9
 ♦ A 8 7 2
 ♣ A 10 9 6

♠ K 3

♥ Q 6 5 2

♦ K 9 4 3

♣ K Q 7



♠ Q 9 8 7 4
 ♥ A J 10 8 3
 ♦ Q 6
 ♣ 5

♠ 6 5 2

♥ 7 4

♦ J 10 5

♣ J 8 4 3 2

EAST has five cards in each Major and WEST opens 1NT.

First EAST bids 2♥, indicating a 5-card ♠ suit with the Transfer bid. Then, after WEST bids the obligatory 2♠, EAST jumps to 4♥, promising enough strength for game, and also five ♥s to go with the five ♠s.

WEST prefers ♠s, so she corrects the contract to 4♠.

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	2♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	4♥	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			
4♠ by West			
Lead: ♣K			

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 3

♥ J 10 5 3

♦ 10 9 7 4

♣ A J 9 3

♠ A 9 6

♥ K Q 6 2

♦ K 5 3 2

♣ K 8



♠ J 10 8 7

♥ A 9 4

♦ Q J 6

♣ 10 5 2

♠ K Q 5 4 2

♥ 8 7

♦ A 8

♣ Q 7 6 4

With 12 points and five ♠s, when SOUTH hears her partner open 1NT she knows there is a game - either 3NT or 4♠.

SOUTH first transfers NORTH to ♠s, then jumps to 3NT, giving NORTH the choice.

NORTH has three ♠s, so he chooses 4♠, taking the 8-card Major fit.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

3NT

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by North

Lead: ♦ Q